



1100 Pennsylvania Av
Monaca, Pa 15061
www.ohiorivertrail.org

Phone: 724.728.2625
Fax: 724.775.9876
drvtrioa@ohiorivertrail.org

Ohio River Trail Council

"Joining communities through fitness, recreation, heritage and transportation networks"

February 14, 2013

Ray McCutcheon, Manager
Borough of Coraopolis
1012 5th Avenue
Coraopolis, PA 15108

Re: Ohio River Trail – Phase I

Dear Mr. McCutcheon,

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is in full support of the Coraopolis application to the Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR) for a \$200,000 Community Conservation Partnerships Program Grant. In 2012, the ORTC successfully submitted an application in behalf of Coraopolis, which was awarded a \$200,000 Transportation, Community and System Preservation Program (TCSP) Grant from the Federal Highway Administration for the development of the Ohio River Trail – Phase I (ORT-PH1). The ORTC is respectfully requesting that DCNR support the ORT-PH1 project. The \$400,000 in funding will employ a consultant to prepare engineering specifications and bid documents and to begin the construction of 2.5-miles of the Ohio River Trail (ORT) through Coraopolis, Moon Township and to Sewickley via the Sewickley Bridge.

The ORT-PH1 is part of the ORTC's overall plan to develop a forty-one mile multi-use land & water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries, known as the Ohio River Trail. The corridor runs from Coraopolis, Pa to Ohioville, Pa near the three-way intersection of OH, PA and WV where the ORT will link to Cleveland and the Great Lakes region via the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway. The ORT-PH1 project is an exciting transportation prospect that it connects two wonderful recreational projects in Allegheny County, the seventy-eight acre Allegheny County Sports & Athletic Complex and the Moon Township Waterfront Park. These two sites are former industrial sites, and are brownfields under redevelopment. In fact, with the support of an ORTC community revitalization initiative, the U.S. EPA funded Partnership for Sustainable Communities Area-Wide Brownfields Planning Project addressed the reclamation and reuse of certain brownfields along the Ohio River including Coraopolis, Pa.

In 2009, the ORTC, in partnership with eight communities along the south shore, received a PA-DCNR Planning Grant to prepare a feasibility study to bond the municipalities together via a multi-modal trail and to improve public access to the Ohio River. The Ohio River South Shore Trail (ORSST) Feasibility Study is complete and has identified a series of proposed recommendations to create a greenway along the Ohio River corridor, which links the current 46-mile Montour Trail and the Great Allegheny Passage to Beaver County, Pa. The Study is available for download at <http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/index.php/ohio-river-trail-south-shore/orsst-feasibility-study>.

From this study, comes the ORT-PH1 request for funding. The ORTC and partners are eager to begin the implementation of the ORSST Feasibility Study and are encouraged about this opportunity to show on-the-ground success of this regional project. In addition, the ORTC is committed to \$5,000 of in-kind volunteer services annually for the operation and maintenance of the completed trail. Please feel free to contact me personally with any questions. The Ohio River Trail Council phone number is 724.728.2625. My direct email is drvtrioa@ohiorivertrail.org

Sincerely,

Vincent Troia

Dr. Vincent Troia, CEO